

Static GK Test -13

Q1. In Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi Yojana, beneficiaries are provided with how much amount every year?

- A) ₹6,000
- B) ₹4,000
- C) ₹5,000
- D) ₹3,000

Solution: 4.(a) ₹6,000 - per year in three equal installments, every four months is transferred into the bank accounts of farmers' families across the country through Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) mode. Implemented by the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare. Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi Yojana launched on 24th February, 2019.

Q2. The Nobel Prize for Physics 2022 has been given in the field of

- A) Atomic Science
- B) Nuclear Physics
- C) Gravitational force
- D) Quantum Mechanics

Solution: 10.(d) Quantum Mechanics: It is the study of how atomic particles exist and interact with each other. Nobel Prize 2022 awards: Physics (Alain Aspect, John F. Clauser and Anton Zeilinger), Chemistry (Carolyn R. Bertozzi, Morten Meldal and K. Barry Sharpless), Medicine (Svante Paabo), Literature (Annie Ernaux), Peace (Ales Bialiatski, the Russian human rights organisation, Ukrainian Center for Civil Liberties), Economics (Ben S. Bernanke, Douglas W. Diamond and Philip H. Dybvig).

Q3. Indira PP Bora is a Padma Shri Awardee 2020 for her contribution to which Indian classical dance?

- A) Sattriya
- B) Kathak
- C) Kuchipudi
- D) Bharatanatyam

Solution: 11.(a) Sattriya. Indira P. P. Bora has won Sangeet Natak Akademi Award in 1996. Dance and their exponents : Sattriya - Sharodi Saikia, Guru Jatin Goswami, Guru Ghanakanta Bora, Manik Barbayan, Pushpa Bhuyan. Kathak - Pandit Birju Maharaj, Ishwari Prasad, Kumudini Lakhia, etc. Kuchipudi - Raja and Radha Reddy, Lakshmi Narayan Shastri, Swapna Sundari, etc. Bharatanatyam - Rukmini Devi Arundale, Meenakshi Sundaram Pillai, T Bala Saraswati, etc.

Q4. In which year was the National Institute of Kathak Dance established?

- A) 1964
- B) 1961
- C) 1954
- D) 1969

Solution: 1.(a) 1964. National Institute of Kathak Dance is also known as Kathak Kendra. It is a unit of the Sangeet Natak Akademy. Other renowned Dance Institutes : Jawaharlal Nehru Manipur Dance Academy (Manipur), Nalanda Nritya Kala Mahavidyalaya (Mumbai), Ballet Repertoire Academy of India (Mumbai), Sri Thyagaraja College of Music and Dance (Hyderabad), and Nrityanjali Institute of Performing Arts (Mumbai).

Q5. Kalamandalam Kalyanikutty Amma was honoured with Kalidasa Samman in 1997-1998. She was famous for which Indian classical dance form?

- A) Mohiniyattam
- B) Kuchipudi
- C) Odissi
- D) Kathak

Solution: 14.(a) Mohiniyattam. Other Personalities related to Mohiniattam dance (kerala) form :- Sunanda Nair, Jayaprabha Menon, Pallavi Krishnan, Vijayalakshmi, Radha Dutta. Kalidasa sammaan Award - Given by Madhya pradesh Government since 1980 in the field of classical music, dance, theater and visual arts. First recipient - Semmangudi Srinivasa and mallikaarjun Mansur.

Q6. The festival of 'Rath Yatra' of Puri in Odisha is dedicated to which

deity?

- A) Lord Jagannath
- B) Lord Ganesha
- C) Lord Shiva
- D) Lord Hanuman

Solution: 1.(a) Lord Jagannath. Rath Yatra Festival : Celebrated on the second day of the bright fortnight in the month of Ashadha, this festival features a public procession with three large chariots carrying the deities Jagannath, Balabhadra, Subhadra. The chariots are pulled towards the Gundicha Temple, located about 3 kilometers away, where the deities stay for seven days before being returned to the main temple. Other festivals in Odisha : Raja Parba, Magha Saptmi, Nuakhai, Chatar Jatra.

Q7. In which year was the PM Ayushman Bharat Health Infrastructure Mission launched?

- A) 2020
- B) 2022
- C) 2021
- D) 2023

Solution: 6.(c) 2021. Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi inaugurated the PM Ayushman Bharat Health Infrastructure Mission, which aims to be one of the largest initiatives in India focused on improving healthcare infrastructure. Related Schemes and Their Launch Years : National Rural Health Mission (2005), Ayushman Bharat (2018), and National Digital Health Mission (2020).

Q8. According to WHO, if a person's BMI is below 18.5 he/she is classified as ____

- A) Healthy
- B) Blind
- C) Underweight
- D) Mentally unfit

Solution: 6.(c) Underweight. BMI (Body mass Index)- It is an individual weight in kilograms (or pounds) divided by the square of height in meters (or feet). According to WHO, for adults over 20 years old, BMI falls into- Underweight (less than 18.5), Normal (18.5 - 24.9), Overweight (25 - 29.9), Obesity (30 - 34.9), Severely obese(35 - 39.9) Morbid obesity (more than 40).

Q9. 'India's Struggle for Independence' is one of the notable books written by ____ .

- A) Sekhar Bandyopadhyay
- B) R.K. Narayana
- C) R.C. Majumdar
- D) Bipan Chandra

Solution: 1.(d) Bipan Chandra. Awards -Padma Bhushan (2010), Most Popular Books - "History of Modern India", "India's Struggle for Independence", "India since Independence", "Freedom Struggle", "India After Independence", "Communalism in Modern India", "In the Name of Democracy", "Indian National Movement", "Bharat me Upniveshvad aur Rashtravad".

Q10. Bharatanatyam dance style is associated with which of the following states?

- A) Karnataka
- B) Tamil Nadu
- C) Bihar
- D) Manipur

Solution: 7.(b) Tamil Nadu. Bharatanatyam is a classical dance form that originated from the art of dancers dedicated to temples and was previously known as Sadir or Dasi Attam. Bharatanatyam is unique because it is an Ekaharya dance, meaning one dancer portrays multiple roles in a single performance. Other classical dance styles : Kathak - Uttar Pradesh, Odissi - Odisha, Kathakali and Mohiniyattam - Kerala, Manipuri - Manipur and Sattriya - Assam.

Q11. Bhupen Hazarika was one of the most well-known personalities from the state of ____.

- A) Odisha
- B) Assam**
- C) Nagaland
- D) Manipur

Solution: 8.(b) Assam. Bhupen Hazarika was a singer known for his baritone voice. He received the National Film Award for Best Music Direction in 1975, the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1987), Bharat Ratna (2019), Padma Vibhushan (2012), Padma Bhushan (2001), and Padma Shri (1977), Dada Saheb Phalke Award (1992), Asom Ratna (2009).

Q12. In which year was the MPLADS scheme implemented?

- A) 2003
- B) 1983
- C) 1993**
- D) 2013

Solution: 6.(c) 1993. Objective : The Member of Parliament Local Area Development Scheme (MPLADS) aims to empower MPs to recommend developmental projects that focus on creating durable community assets in areas such as drinking water, primary education, public health, sanitation, and road infrastructure, primarily within their constituencies. Each year, MPs receive ₹5 crore in two installments of ₹2.5 crore each. Notably, the funds allocated under MPLADS are non-lapsable.

Q13. International Women's Day is celebrated on?

- A) 12th march
- B) 8th march**
- C) 8th july
- D) 12th july

Solution: 4.(b) 8th march. International Women's Day (IWD) is a global day celebrating the social, economic, cultural and political achievements of women. It is also celebrated to honor the movement for women's rights and to build support for achieving universal suffrage for women. 12th March- National Girl Scout Day and National Napping Day. 26th August - Women's Equality Day.

Q14. The shehnai is a reed instrument with how many holes along the tubes?

- A) Five
- B) Seven**
- C) Eleven
- D) Six

Solution: 2.(b) Seven. Shehnai - It is a reed instrument in which there are seven holes along the tube which are used for playing the melody by opening and closing them with the fingers. It is known as Mangal Vadya. It is considered to have come to India from West Asia. In the early fifties of this century, Ustad Bismillah Khan is credited for popularising this instrument. Pt. Anant Lal and Pt. Daya Shankar is also a noted Shehnai player.

Q15. Prabha Atre, who received the Padma Vibhushan Award 2022, belongs to which Gharana?

- A) Indore gharana
- B) Kirana gharana**
- C) Agra gharana
- D) Mewati gharana

Solution: 7.(b) Kirana gharana. It was founded by Ustad Abdul Karim Khan. Famous artists such as Abdul Wahid Khan, Suresh Babu Mane, Hira Bai Badodekar and Roshanara Begum belong to this Gharana. Awards of Prabha Atre : Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1991) for her contribution to Hindustani vocal music. Gharana and their Founders : Indore gharana (Amir Khan), Agra gharana (Hajisujan Khan), Mewati gharana (Ustad Wahid Khan and Ustad Ghagge Nazir Khan), Jaipur Atrauli (Alladiya Khan).

Q16. Shri Jatin Goswami received several honours for his contribution to

- A) Bharatnatyam Dance
- B) Kathak Dance
- C) Sattriya Dance**
- D) Manipuri Dance

Solution: 9.(c) Sattriya dance (Assam): Guru Jatin Goswami (Padma Shri in 2008) and Sharodi Saikia. Bharatnatyam dance (Tamil Nadu): Rukmini Devi, Padma Subrahmanyam, Alarinel Valli, Yamini Krishnamurthy, Mallika Sarabhai. Kathak dance (Uttar Pradesh): Pandit Birju Maharaj, Lachu Maharaj, Shovna Narayan, Kumari Kamala, Pandit Durgalal, Prerana Shrimala, Sitara Devi. Manipuri dance (Manipur): Darshana Jhaveri, Yumlembam Gambhini Devi, Nirmala Mehta, Guru Bipin Singh, Devyani Chalia.

Q17. Who among the following was known as the 'Queen of Thumri' ?

- A) Siddheswari Devi
- B) Girija Devi**
- C) Gangubai Hangal
- D) Begum Parveen Sultana

Solution: 4.(b) Girija Devi. Awards - Padma Shri (1972), Padma Bhushan (1989), Padma Vibhushan (2016), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1977), Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship (2010). Siddheswari Devi - She was a legendary Hindustani singer from Varanasi, India, known as 'Maa' (mother). Gangubai Hangal - She was an Indian singer of the khayal genre of Hindustani classical music from Karnataka. Begum Parveen Sultana - She is an Indian Hindustani classical singer of the Patiala Gharana. She was awarded the Padma Shri in 1976 and the Padma Bhushan in 2014.

Q18. Which of the following pairs of "term - sports" is correct ? I. Eagle - Hockey II. Penalty kick - Volleyball

- A) Only I
- B) Both I and II
- C) Neither I nor II**
- D) Only II

Solution: 7.(c) Neither I nor II. Hockey terminology- Striking Circle, Scoop, Back stick, Faceoff, Sticks, Penalty Corner, etc. Volleyball Terminology- Six Pack, Double Block, Jump Serve, Wipe, Dump, Slide, Side Arm Serve, etc. Golf Terminology - Eagle, Bogey, Birdie, Double Bogey, Hook, Fairway, Rough etc. Football Terminology- Free Kick, Dead Ball, Foul, Penalty kick, Dead Ball, Scissor Kick etc.

Q19. Which among the following festivals is celebrated as the Telugu New Year?

- A) Dasara
- B) Vishu
- C) Ugadi**
- D) Monpa

Solution: 3.(c) Ugadi comes in the spring season (usually March or April). It is celebrated according to the Luni-Solar calendar in the states of Andhra Pradesh, Telangana and Karnataka. It also marks the beginning of new Samvatsara (a cycle of sixty years). People also refer Ugadi as Gudi Padwa in Maharashtra and Visu in Kerala and Tamilnadu. Monpa is a major tribe of Arunachal Pradesh. New Year festival :- Bohag Bihu (Assam), Cheti Chand (Sindhi), Pana Sankranti (Odisha), Pohela Boishakh (West Bengal), Puthandu (Tamil), Vaisakhi (Punjab), Vishu (Malayalam), Bestu Varas (Gujarat), Losoong (Sikkim), Navreh (Kashmir), Hijri (Islam), Losar (Arunachal Pradesh), Nowruz (Persian).

Q20. Who won India's first badminton medal in the Olympics games?

- A) P.V.Sindhu
- B) Prakash Padukone
- C) Saina Nehwal**
- D) Pullela Gopichand

Solution: 14.(c) Saina Nehwal. She became the first Indian female to win a 4-star tournament in 2006. Medal Record - Bronze (Olympics, 2012), Gold (2010 and 2018 Commonwealth). Awards - Arjuna Award (2009), Padma Shri (2010), Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna (2009–2010); Padma Bhushan (2016).

Q21. Jagoi and cholom are the two main divisions in_____dance.

- A) Kathakali
- B) Manipuri**
- C) Bharatanatyam
- D) Kathak

Solution: 4.(b) Manipuri. Varieties of Manipuri forms of dance: Raas, Sankirtan, Dhola Chalam, Kartal Chalam, Pung Chalam (Dancers playing pung/drum while dancing), and Thang ta (martial art form).

Q22. Hari Prasad Chaurasia is associated with which of the following instruments?

- A) Bansuri
- B) Tabla
- C) Drum
- D) Veena

Solution: 5.(a) Bansuri. Personalities associated with Bansuri- Rakesh Chaurasia, Milind Date, Devendra Murdeshwar, Pannalal Ghosh, Keshav Ginde, Pravin Godkhindi, etc. Tabla- Ustad Ahmed Jan Thirakwa, Ustad Alla Rakha, Ustad Zakir Hussain, Pandit Yogesh Shamsi, Pandit Suresh Talwalkar, Pandit Anindo Chatterjee, etc. Veena- Emani Sankara Sastry, Veena E. Gayathri, Rajhesh Vaidhya, Karaikudi Subramaniam & Trichy Sankaran, etc.

Q23. Who has written the book 'Fearless Governance', published in January 2021, describing her stint as Governor?

- A) Draupadi Murmu
- B) Baby Rani Maurya
- C) Kiran Bedi
- D) Anandi ben Patel

Solution: .12.(c) Kiran Bedi. She is the first woman in India to join the officer ranks of the Indian Police Service (IPS) in 1972. Her other books: 'It's always possible', 'Himmat Hai', 'Dare to Do! For the New Generation'.

Q24. In which of the following years did India NOT host the ICC Cricket World Cup Tournament?

- A) 2011
- B) 1996
- C) 1983
- D) 1987

Solution: 5.(c) 1983. The Cricket World Cup, officially known as the ICC Men's Cricket World Cup, is the international championship of One Day International (ODI) cricket. Organized by the International Cricket Council (ICC), the tournament is held every four years. Host Countries of the ICC Cricket World Cup: 1983 - England and Wales; 1987 - India and Pakistan; 1996 - India, Pakistan and Sri Lanka; 2011 - India, Sri Lanka and Bangladesh; 2023 - India; 2027 - Namibia, South Africa and Zimbabwe; 2031 - Bangladesh and India.

Q25. Follow On is related to which of the following cricket formats?

- A) Only T20 matches
- B) Only Test Matches
- C) Only One Day matches
- D) Both test and One-day matches

Solution: 12.(b) Only Test Matches. Follow-on: The follow on forces the team batting second to bat again just after the original innings has finished. In a match of five days or more, a side which bats first and leads by at least 200 runs has the option of requiring the other side to follow-on.

Q26. Who among the following was revered as the 'Queen of Thumri'?

- A) Naina Devi
- B) Siddheshwari Devi
- C) Girija Devi
- D) Annapurna Devi

Solution: 11.(c) Girija Devi. She was an Indian classical singer of the Seniya and Banaras gharanas. Awards - Padma Shri (1972), Padma Bhushan (1989), Padma Vibhushan (2016), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1977), Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship (2010). Thumri is a vocal genre of Indian music. Famous Singers of Thumri - Gauhar Jan, Begum Akhtar, Shobha Gurtu, Noor Jehan.

Q27. When was the pro kabaddi league inaugurated for the first time in India?

- A) 2007

- B) 2008
- C) 2015
- D) 2014

Solution: 5.(d) 2014. The duration of the match is divided into two halves of 20 minutes each. The Kabaddi court measures 13 × 10 meters for men and 12 × 8 meters for women. The Women Kabaddi Challenge was first played in 2016. The 2019 Kabaddi World Cup was held in Malaysia. It is the largest World Cup in the history of kabaddi, consisting of 32 men's teams and 24 women's teams.

Q28. The Corbillon Cup is associated with which of the following sports?

- A) Golf
- B) Hockey
- C) Table Tennis
- D) Badminton

Solution: 15.(c) Table Tennis. The Corbillon Cup is awarded to the winning team of the women's team event at the World Table Tennis Championships. Cups and trophy: Golf - Ryder Cup, Aga Khan Gold Cup. Hockey - Jawaharlal Nehru Cup, Murugappa Gold Cup. Badminton - Thomas Cup, Uber Cup.

Q29. Lata Mangeskar recorded her first playback song for a _____ film.

- A) Bengali
- B) Punjabi
- C) Marathi
- D) Tamil

Solution: 10.(c) Marathi. Lata Mangeskar - She recorded her first song "Naachu Ya Gade, Khelu Saari Mani Haus Bhaari" in 1942 at age of 13 for Marathi film Kiti Hasaal and recorded her last song 'Saugandh Mujhe Is Mitti Ki' in 2019. Award: - Dadasaheb Phalke Award (1989), Bharat Ratna (2001), Officer of the Legion of Honour (Highest civilian award of France) in 2007.

Q30. In June 2022, Google Doodle honoured Satyendra Nath Bose, he was an/a _____.

- A) Indian Classical dancer
- B) Indian Physicist
- C) Indian Singer
- D) Supreme Court Judge

Solution: 9.(b) Indian physicist. Satyendra Nath Bose - He was known for his work on Planck's Law and Light Quantum Hypothesis. The word 'boson (God particle)' was named after him. He worked with Albert Einstein on a theory about the gas-like properties of electromagnetic radiation. He was nominated for a Nobel prize. In 1954, He received the Padma Vibhushan award.

Q31. Which of the following numbers best describes the number of white pieces used in chess?

- A) 18
- B) 16
- C) 19
- D) 17

Solution: 9.(b) 16. There are six different types of chess pieces. Each side starts with 16 pieces : eight pawns, two bishops, two knights, two rooks, one queen, and one king. King : Moves one square in any direction. Queen : Moves any number of squares diagonally, horizontally, or vertically. Rook : Moves any number of squares horizontally or vertically. Bishop : Moves any number of squares diagonally. Knight : Moves in an 'L-shape' (two squares in one direction and then one square perpendicular). Pawn : Moves one square forward (two squares on its first move) and captures diagonally one square forward.

Q32. Padma Subrahmanyam is a well-known dancer of which of the following dance forms?

- A) Bharatnatyam
- B) Manipuri
- C) Odissi
- D) Kuchipudi

Solution: 3.(a) Bharatnatyam:- An Indian classical dance form that originated in Tamil Nadu. It is one of eight Indian classical dance forms recognized by the Sangeet Natak Akademi. Padma Subrahmanyam is well known as the developer and founder of the dance form Bharata Nrithyam. Awards won - Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1983), Padma Bhushan (2003), Padma Shri (1981).

Q33. Identify the famous Indian music personality. In 2011, the Guinness Book of World Records officially acknowledged her as the most recorded artist in music history.

- A) Asha Bhosle
- B) Shreya Ghoshal
- C) Usha Uthup
- D) Alka Yagnik

Solution: 3.(a) Asha Bhosle. She has recorded over 12000 songs in more than 20 Indian and foreign languages. The World Records Academy certified her as the "Most Recorded Artist" in the world in September 2009. Awards: Won seven Filmfare Best Female Playback Awards, nominated for the Grammy Award, Padma Vibhushan (2008), Dadasaheb Phalke Award (2000).

Q34. Which Indian marathon event is considered the largest marathon in Asia?

- A) Kaveri Trail Marathon
- B) Pinkathon
- C) Delhi Half Marathon
- D) Mumbai Marathon

Solution: 10.(d) Mumbai Marathon. The TATA Mumbai Marathon (TMM) is recognized as the largest marathon in Asia and the continent's biggest mass participation sporting event. Since its inception in 2004, the marathon unites people from diverse backgrounds through the joy of running. It showcases the city's spirit in supporting various charities, providing a platform for runners to raise awareness and funds for causes they care about.

Q35. Gangu bai Hangal and Prabha Atre were exponents of the _____ Gharana.

- A) Rampur
- B) Jaipur
- C) Kirana
- D) Mewati

Solution: 13.(c) Kirana. Gangu Bai Hangal was an Indian singer of the khayal genre of Hindustani classical music from Karnataka. She received the Padma Shri in 1962, the Padma Bhushan in 1971, and the Padma Vibhushan in 2002. Prabha Atre is another renowned Indian classical vocalist. She received the Padma Shri in 1990, the Padma Bhushan in 2002, and the Padma Vibhushan in 2022 and Sangeet Natak Academy Award in 1991. Abdul Karim Khan was the founder of the Kirana Gharana. Some exponents: Abdul Wahid Khan, Ashique Ali Khan, Roshan Ara Begum.

Q36. MG Music Awards is presented annually by which of the following states?

- A) Mizoram
- B) Nagaland
- C) Manipur
- D) Chhattisgarh

Solution: 4.(b) Nagaland. The MG Music Awards is an annual music awards ceremony organized by the Musicians Guild Nagaland. The first edition of the awards was held online on June 21, 2021, due to the COVID-19 pandemic. The second edition was held offline at the RCEMPA Hall in Jotsoma, Nagaland in 2022.

Q37. Identify the Indian classical dancer associated with Kathak.

- A) Vedantam Satyanarayana Sarma
- B) Kelucharan Mohapatra
- C) Rohini Bhate
- D) Sharodi Saikia

Solution: 3.(c) Rohini Bhate. She received the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award in 1979. Other Exponents : Kathak (Uttar Pradesh) - Pandit Birju

Maharaj, Sonal Mansingh, Shambhu Maharaj. Kuchipudi (Andhra Pradesh) - Vedantam Satyanarayana Sarma, Mallika Sarabhai, Bhavana Reddy. Odissi (Odisha) - Kelucharan Mohapatra, Sanjukta Panigrahi, Gangadhar Pradhan. Sattriya (Assam) - Sharodi Saikia, Guru Jatin Goswami.

Q38. Which famous sportsperson has received the Bharat Ratna award in 2014?

- A) Ravi Shastri
- B) Yogeshwar Dutt
- C) MS Dhoni
- D) Sachin Tendulkar

Solution: 1.(d) Sachin Tendulkar has received several awards from the government of India: Arjuna Award (1994), Khel Ratna Award (1997), Maharashtra Bhushan Award (2001), Padma Shri (1999), Padma Vibhushan (2008). Bharat Ratna (Highest civilian Award of the country) was instituted in the year 1954.

Q39. 'The Inheritance of Loss' book is written by_____.

- A) Kiran Desai
- B) VS Naipaul
- C) Ruskin Bond
- D) Salman Rushdie

Solution: 13.(a) Kiran Desai - She won the man booker prize (2006) for 'The Inheritance of Loss'. Her other books - 'Emblems of Transformation', 'Hullabaloo in the Guava Orchard', 'India pack'. Salman Rushdie - 'Midnight's Children', 'The Satanic Verses', 'Haroun and the Sea of Stories', 'Imaginary Homelands', 'The Golden House'. Ruskin Bond - 'Blue Umbrella', 'School Times', 'Delhi is not far', 'The Great Train Journey', 'A Flight of Pigeons'. VS Naipaul - 'A House for Mr Biswas', 'A Bend in the River', 'Half a Life'.

Q40. Shab-e-Barat is celebrated by which religious group?

- A) Muslim
- B) Buddhist
- C) Jain
- D) Parsi

Solution: 11.(a) Muslim. Shab-e-Barat, also known as Mid-Sha'ban, is observed on the 15th night of Sha'ban in the Islamic calendar. Festivals celebrated by : Muslim - Eid al-Fitr, Eid al-Adha etc; Buddhist - Buddha Purnima, Vesak etc; Jain - Mahavir Jayanti, Paryushana etc; Parsi - Navroz, Jamshedi Navroz etc.

Q41. Dussehra festival is also known as_____.

- A) Sankranti
- B) Vaikunthashtami
- C) Vijayadashami
- D) Janmasthmi

Solution: 8.(c) Vijayadashami (Dashain) - A Hindu festival celebrated at the end of Sharad Navaratri every year. It is observed on the tenth day in the Hindu calendar month of Ashvin (September-October). It marks the end of Durga Puja. It marks the end of Ramlila and remembers god Rama's victory over Ravana. Ramlila was added to UNESCO's list of Intangible Cultural Heritage in 2008. Dashain is a festival celebrated in Nepal. It symbolises the victory of good over evil.

Q42. Who has written "The History of British India" in 1817?

- A) James Mill
- B) Romesh Chander Dutt
- C) Dadabhai Naoroji
- D) William Bentick

Solution: 2.(a) James Mill. He was the first writer to divide Indian history into three parts: Hindu, Muslim and British. The Book "History of British India" - Displays the history, character, religion, literature, arts and laws of India, influence of the Indian climate. Other writers and their books - Romesh Chander Dutt - "The economic history of India". Dadabhai Naoroji through his book, "Poverty and Unbritish Rule in India" made the earliest estimation (1901) of the poverty line.

Q43. Which of the following Table Tennis World Championship events was held in India?

- A) 19th World Championships, 1952**
- B) 17th World Championships, 1950
- C) 20th World Championships, 1953
- D) 18th World Championships, 1951

Solution: 14.(a) 19th World Championships, 1952 were held in Mumbai. India has also hosted the 1987 World Table Tennis Championships in New Delhi. The World Table Tennis Championships are table tennis competitions sanctioned by the International Table Tennis Federation (ITTF). The first event was held in 1926 in London, England. The 56th edition took place in 2024 in Busan, South Korea, and the 58th edition will be held in 2025 in Doha, Qatar.

Q44. Who among the following wrote "The Bench"?

- A) Amitav Ghosh
- B) Meghan Markle**
- C) Kalki Koechlin
- D) Samir Soni

Solution: 13.(b) Meghan Markle. Books of Amitabh Ghosh: "Sea of Poppies", "The Hungry Tide", "The Glass Palace", "The Great Derangement": "Climate Change and the unthinkable", "River of Smoke", Kalki Koechlin: "Skeleton Woman", "The Elephant In The Womb", Samir Soni: "My Experiments with Silence": "The Diary Of-An-Introvert".

Q45. Who among the following is a Sarod player popularly known as 'Sarod Samrat'?

- A) Pandit Kishan Maharaj
- B) Pandit Ravi Shankar
- C) Ustad Amjad Ali Khan Bangash**
- D) Pandit Shivkumar Sharma

Solution: 13.(c) Ustad Amjad Ali Khan Bangash: Awards - Padma Shri (1975), Padma Bhushan (1991), Padma Vibhushan (2001). Other Sarod Players: Allauddin Khan, Hafiz Ali Khan, Ali Akbar Khan, Radhika Mohan Maitra, Sharan Rani Backliwal, Zarin Sharma, Buddhadev Das Gupta, Rajeev Taranath, Aashish Khan, Tejendra Majumdar etc.

Q46. Which of the following cups/trophies is NOT related to the Indian domestic cricket?

- A) Duleep Trophy
- B) Durand Cup**
- C) Deodhar Trophy
- D) Ranji Trophy

Solution: 15.(b) Durand Cup is an annual domestic football competition in India which was first held in 1888 in Shimla, Himachal Pradesh. Domestic cricket competitions in India : The Vijay Hazare Trophy, The Irani Trophy and The NKP Salve Challenger Trophy.

Q47. Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana- Urban was launched by which Union Ministry?

- A) Ministry of Finance
- B) Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs**
- C) Ministry of Human Resource Development
- D) Ministry of Rural Development

Solution: 5.(b) Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs. It was launched on 25th June 2015 and intends to provide housing for all in urban areas by the year 2022. It makes home loans affordable for the urban poor by providing a subsidy on the Interest Rate of a home loan during repayment by way of EMI (Equated Monthly Instalments). Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana - Gramin (PMAY-G) - It was launched in June 2015 with the aim to provide 'Housing for All' by 2022 in rural areas. It is a centrally sponsored scheme. Target - To construct 2.95 crore pucca houses with basic amenities by March 2024.

Q48. Ugadi is a Telugu festival celebrated on the occasion of_____.

- A) birth of lord Krishna
- B) birth of lord Rama
- C) coming of monsoon
- D) Telugu new year**

Solution: 14.(d) Telugu new year. Ugadi festival : Celebrated as a new year in South India (majorly Karnataka); Celebrated on the first day of Chaitra month; Lord Brahma, the creator of the universe, is worshiped; A drink called Pachadi is made. Major Festivals of Karnataka : Kambala Festival, Hampi Festival, Pattadakal Dance Festival, Makar Sankranti, Vairamudi Festival, Karaga Festival, Vara Mahalakshmi Pooja, Ganesh Chaturthi, Gowri Festival, Sri Vithappa Fair, Dussehra, Tula Sankramana, Karnataka Rajyotsava, Deepavali, Groundnut Festival, Mahamastakabhisheka.

Q49. The Ugadi festival in India celebrates the _____.

- A) first rainfall
- B) commencement of new year**
- C) harvesting season
- D) monsoon season

Solution: 8.(b) Commencement of new year. Ugadi festival (Karnataka, Telangana and Andhra Pradesh). On the day of Ugadi, Lord Brahma, the creator of the universe, is worshiped. Other state festivals: Andhra Pradesh - Pedda Panduga (Sankranti). Assam - Bihu. Gujarat - Rann utsav. Kerala - Onam, Vishu. Jharkhand - Karam Utsav. Madhya Pradesh - Lok-rang Utsav. Nagaland - Hornbill, Sekrenyi, Tsukheneye.

Q50. Paryushana festival is celebrated by the people of which of the following communities?

- A) Jain**
- B) Muslim
- C) Hindu
- D) Sikh

Solution: 10.(a) Jain. This 8-10 days festival inspires Jains worldwide to remember the roots and philosophies of Jainism. Celebrating paryushan also brings a social purpose as well. Other Religious festivals : Jain - Mahavir Jayanti, Rohini Vrat, Samvatsari, Meru Trayodashi etc. Muslim - Eid ul Fitr, Eid ul Adha, Ramadan, Muharram etc. Sikh - Hola Mohalla, Vaisakhi, Maghi etc. Hindu - Holi, Diwali, Rakshabandhan etc.

Q51. Sreejesh P.R who was awarded "Major Dyan Chand Khel Ratna Award 2021" is associated with which sports?

- A) Football
- B) Boxing
- C) Wrestling
- D) Hockey**

Solution: 7.(d) Hockey. Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna Award : Previously known as the Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna Award is the highest sporting honour of India. It is awarded annually by the "Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports". The award comprises a medallion, a certificate, and a cash prize of Rs. 25 lakh. Winner (2022) - Achanta Sharath Kamal (Table Tennis). First recipient (1991-92) - Viswanathan Anand (Chess).

Q52. Where is the headquarters of the Spices Board of India located?

- A) Bengaluru (Karnataka)
- B) Kochi (Kerala)**
- C) Pune (Maharashtra)
- D) Guntur (Andhra Pradesh)

Solution: 1.(b) Kochi (Kerala). Spices Board is a statutory body constituted since 1987 under the Spices Board Act, 1986 by merging the erstwhile Cardamom Board and Spices Export Promotion Council under the administrative control of the Department of Commerce. Kerala is known as the spice garden of India.

Q53. Malgudi Days is a collection of short stories by .

- A) Jhumpa Lahiri
- B) R.K. Narayana**
- C) Chetan Bhagat
- D) Amish Tripathi

Solution: 13.(b) R.K. Narayana. Awards - Padma Vibhushan (2000); Sahitya Akademi Award (1960). Other Writers - Chetan Bhagat - "Five Point Someone" "One Arranged Murder". Amish Tripathi - "War of Lanka", "The Secrets of Nagas". Jhumpa Lahiri - "The Namesake", "Interpreter of Maladies".

Q54. Consider the following statements and choose the correct statement(s) from the following: 1. The UDAN scheme has completed five years since its implementation in 2017. 2. It is the flagship scheme of the Ministry of Science and Technology. 3. The Airports Authority of India is the implementing agency of this scheme.

- A) Only statement 3
- B) Only statement 2
- C) Only statements 2 and 3
- D) Only statements 1 and 3**

Solution: 9.(d) Only statements 1 and 3. The UDAN (Ude Desh ka Aam Nagrik) scheme is an initiative by the Indian government aimed at enhancing connectivity to remote and regional areas while making air travel more affordable. The scheme was introduced in 2016 as part of the National Civil Aviation Policy. First Flight : The first flight under the UDAN scheme, from Shimla to Delhi, was flagged off by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in 2017. Nodal Ministry: Ministry of Civil Aviation.

Q55. The Maharashtra Bhushan was conferred upon ____ in the year 2002.

- A) Pandit Ravi Shankar
- B) Pandit Bhimsen Joshi**
- C) Pandit Jasraj
- D) Pandit Hari Prasad Chaurasia

Solution: 15.(b) Pandit Bhimsen Joshi. He belongs to the Kirana gharana tradition of Hindustani Classical Music. Awards - Bharat Ratna (2009), Padma Vibhushan (1999), Padma Bhushan (1985), Padma Shri (1972), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award for Hindustani vocal music (1975), Aditya Vikram Birla Kalashikhar Puraskar (2000).

Q56. On which of the following dates does India celebrate its Constitution Day?

- A) 26th January
- B) 26th November**
- C) 15th August
- D) 2nd October

Solution: 8.(b) 26th November. The Constitution of India was adopted on 26 November 1949, that is why Constitution Day is celebrated on 26 November. 15th August : Independence Day (commemorating India's independence from British rule in 1947). 2nd October : Gandhi Jayanti (the birthday of Mahatma Gandhi, celebrated as a national holiday and also observed as International Day of Non-Violence). 26th January : Republic Day (the Constitution of India came into force on 26 January 1950).

Q57. The Ravan Phadi cave in is an example of the early Chalukya style architecture which is known for its distinct sculptural style.

- A) Tamil Nadu
- B) Kerala
- C) Andhra Pradesh
- D) Karnataka**

Solution: 12.(d) Karnataka. Ravana Phadi Cave Temple is one of the jewels in the Aihole monuments. Other Historic Caves: Maharashtra - Ajanta Caves, Ellora Caves, Elephanta Caves. Kerala - Edakkal caves, Maniyoar caves, Ezhuthupara cave. Andhra Pradesh - Erravaram Caves, Belum Caves, Akkanna Madanna Caves.

Q58. When was the Indian Hockey Federation established?

- A) 1925**
- B) 1955
- C) 1945
- D) 1935

Solution: 2.(a) 1925. Indian Hockey Federation was the administrative body of field hockey in India. Headquarters - New Delhi. The International Hockey Federation was established in Paris in 1924, initiated by Paul Leautey.

Q59. How many silver medals were won by India in London Olympics 2012?

- A) Two**
- B) One
- C) Three
- D) Four

Solution: 15.(a) Two. In 2012 India won six Olympic medals, including two silver and four bronze. Silver - Sushil Kumar (wrestling) and Vijay Kumar (pistol shooting). Norman Pritchard was 1st Indian to win the Silver Medal in Paris 1900. Olympic Games Tokyo 2020 - Neeraj Chopra (Gold medal in men's javelin throw). Mirabai Chanu (Silver in the women's 49kg), Bajrang Punia - (Bronze medal in men's 65 kg wrestling).

Q60. "Thomas Cup" is related to which of the following sports?

- A) Football
- B) Cricket
- C) Tennis
- D) Badminton**

Solution: 12.(d) Badminton. Thomas Cup (World Men's Team Championships) founded in 1949, Since 1982 - Biennial. India won 1st title in 2022. Most titles - Indonesia (14 titles). Uber cup - World Women Team Championships. Other famous badminton leagues - Sudirman cup, BWF Super Series, Singapore open. Tennis - Wimbledon, Australian Open, French Open, US Open.

Q61. The novel 'The Palace of Illusions' is written by _____.

- A) Kiran Desai
- B) Amish Tripathi
- C) Indu Sundaresan
- D) Chitra Banerjee Divakaruni**

Solution: 9.(d) Chitra Banerjee Divakaruni. Books - "Black Candle", "Leaving Yuba City". Amish Tripathi Books - "Sita", "Nagas", "Suheldev", "Raavan". Indu Sundaresan Books - "The Mountain of Light", "The splendor of silence", "Shadow of princess". Kiran Desai Books - "The Inheritance of Loss".

Q62. Which of the following festivals is celebrated in Madhya Pradesh?

- A) Thaipusam Festival
- B) Jaisalmer Desert Festival
- C) Bihu Festival
- D) Khajuraho Dance Festival**

Solution: 14.(d) Khajuraho Dance Festival - Organized by the Kala Parishad of the Madhya Pradesh government. It is a seven-day long festival which usually takes place from the 20th of February to the 26th of February. It is held at Khajuraho temples. It was started in 1975. Some festivals which have been organized in Madhya Pradesh are Jal Mahotsav, Mandu Mahotsav, Orchha Mahotsav, Satpura Cycle Safari, Heritage Run.

Q63. Who among the following was awarded the Bharat Ratna in 2001 and has been credited with taking the shehnai from the marriage mandap to the concert hall?

- A) Ravi Shankar
- B) Ali Akbar Khan
- C) Hariprasad Chaurasia
- D) Bismillah Khan**

Solution: 2.(d) Bismillah Khan (Ustad). Awards: Bharat Ratna (2001), Padma Vibhushan (1980), Padma Bhushan (1968), Padma Shri (1961), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1956), Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship (1994), Swathi Sangeetha Puraskaram (1998) by Government of Kerala, T Choudayya National Award (1995) by Government of Karnataka, Tahar Mausique from the Republic of Iran (1992), Tansen Award by Govt. of Madhya Pradesh.

Q64. Which Indian player is also called as Dhing Express?

- A) Dutee Chand
- B) P.T. Usha
- C) Neeraj Chopra
- D) Hima Das**

Solution: 12.(d) Hima Das: First Indian athlete to win a gold medal in a track event at the IAAF World U20 Championships. Dutee Chand - first Indian to win a gold medal in 100m race in a global competition, P.T. Usha (Queen of track and field), Neeraj Chopra (Golden boy) - first Asian athlete to win an Olympic gold medal in Men's Javelin throw.

Q65. Which folk dance of Rajasthan is also known as 'Sapera dance'?

- A) Gair
- B) Kalbelia**
- C) Chari
- D) Ghoomar

Solution: 10.(b) Kalbelia dance (Snake Charmer Dance). It is mainly performed by the Kalbelia Community in Rajasthan. Gair dance is one of the popular, famous folk dances from Rajasthan in India which is mostly performed by the Bhil community. Ghoomar (ghumar) is a traditional folk dance of Rajasthan. Chari dance is prominent in the Gujar and Saini community in Rajasthan.

Q66. A biopic on legendary Sitara Devi has been announced on her 101st birth anniversary by producer Raj C Anand. Sitara Devi was a recognized _____ dancer.

- A) Kathak**
- B) Odissi
- C) Kathakali
- D) Kuchipudi

Solution: 7.(a) Kathak. Sitara Devi: Awards - Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1969), Padma Shri (1973), Kalidas Samman (1995). Famous dancers: Kathak (Uttar Pradesh) - Birju Maharaj, Shambhu Maharaj, Gopi Krishna, Damayanti Joshi, Lachhu Maharaj. Odissi (Odisha) - Sonal Mansingh, Kelucharan Mohapatra, Madhavi Mudgal. Kathakali (Kerala) - Kalamandalam Gopi, Ramankutty Nair, Milena Salvini.

Q67. Who among the following is the author of the book "An Autobiography: Toward Freedom"?

- A) Lala Lajpat Rai
- B) Jawaharlal Nehru**
- C) Indira Gandhi
- D) Mahatma Gandhi

Solution: 6.(b) Jawaharlal Nehru. Other books by Jawaharlal Nehru - "The Discovery of India", "Letters from a Father to his Daughter", "Glimpses of World History". Other eminent personalities and their books - Mahatma Gandhi - "My Experiments with Truth", "The Power of Nonviolent Resistance", "India of my Dreams". Lala Lajpat Rai - "Unhappy India", "Young India". Indira Gandhi - "Eternal India", "Peoples and problems".

Q68. Jhijhiya is a famous folk dance of which of the following states?

- A) Haryana
- B) Bihar**
- C) Rajasthan
- D) Uttar Pradesh

Solution: 11.(b) Bihar. Jhijhiya Dance - Performed at the time of Dussehra in mithila region. Other folk dances of Bihar - Bidesiya, Fagua (Holi), Kajari (bhojpur), Domkach (Marriage ceremony). Haryana - Phag, Saang, Chhathi (on birth), Loor, Gugga, Khorla. Rajasthan - Kalbelia, Ghoomar, Chari, Bhavai, Chakri, Gawri, Terah Taali, Kathputli. Uttar pradesh - Nautanki, Raslila, Khyal, Charkula.

Q69. Chhau dance is a popular dance of which region of India?

- A) Southern India
- B) Northern India
- C) Eastern India**
- D) Western India

Solution: 11.(c) Eastern India. Chhau dance - tribal martial art dance performed in Odisha, Jharkhand, and West Bengal, recreates scenes from epics such as the Mahabharata and Ramayana, included in the UNESCO's Representative List of Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity in 2010.

Q70. The book titled 'The Ministry of Utmost Happiness' has been written by_____.

- A) Jia Pingwa
- B) Dan Brown
- C) Arundhati Roy**
- D) Sunita Narain

Solution: 8.(c) Arundhati Roy. More books by her:- "The God of Small

Things", "The End of Imagination", "The Cost of Living", "The Algebra of Infinite Justice", "Walking with the Comrades", "Kashmir: The Case for Freedom". "Capitalism: A Ghost Story". Jia Pingwa ("Ruined City and Qin Opera"). Daniel Gerhard Brown Angels & Demons, The Da Vinci Code, The Lost Symbol, Inferno , and Origin . Sunita Narain- She is a writer and environmentalist. In 2005 she was awarded the Padma Shri by the Indian government.

Q71. Tera Tali folk dance is primarily associated with which of the following states?

- A) Rajasthan**
- B) Assam
- C) Madhya Pradesh
- D) Haryana

Solution: 2.(a) Rajasthan. Terah Tali Dance : This dance is performed in praise of the folk god Ramdevji, primarily by the Kamar tribe. During the performance, women sit on the ground and use thirteen cymbals on various body parts, synchronizing the swinging Manjeeras with the rhythm of the background music. Rajasthani folk dances : Chari, Ghoomar, Kalbelia, Kathputli dance and Gair folk dance.

Q72. Which among the following dance forms was originally performed in the temples of Tamil Nadu, by the Devadasis and therefore it is also known as Dasiattam?

- A) Kuchipudi
- B) Bharatnatyam**
- C) Odissi
- D) Manipuri

Solution: 5.(b) Bharatnatyam. Some famous Bharatnatyam Dancers - Rukmini Devi, Padma Subrahmanyam, Alamel Valli, Yamini Krishnamurthy, Mallika Sarabhai, etc. Kathak - Uttar Pradesh, Kuchipudi - Andhra Pradesh, Odissi - Odisha, Kathakali - Kerala, Sattriya - Assam, Manipuri - Manipur, Mohiniyattam - Kerala.

Q73. Which Indian city is also known as Queen of Deccan?

- A) Ahmedabad
- B) Pune**
- C) Amritsar
- D) Puducherry

Solution: 15. (b) Pune. Some Indian Cities and Sobriquets : City of Taj - Agra (Uttar Pradesh), Boston/Manchester of India - Ahmedabad (Gujarat), Sangam City - Allahabad (Uttar Pradesh), Land of Black Diamond - Asansol (West Bengal), City of Peace - Bardhaman (West Bengal), Temple City of India - Bhubaneswar (Odisha), The Venice of the East - Alappuzha (Kerala), Garden City of India - Bengaluru (Karnataka), Detroit of Asia - Chennai (Tamil Nadu), Manchester of South India - Coimbatore (Tamil Nadu), Scotland of India - Coorg (Karnataka), School Capital of India - Dehradun (Uttarakhand), Queen of the Hills - Darjeeling (West Bengal).

Q74. Pradhan Mantri Gramodaya Yojana was launched in _____.

- A) 2000**
- B) 2010
- C) 2005
- D) 1998

Solution: 6.(a) 2000. Pradhan Mantri Gramodaya Yojana - It was started to improve the lives of the rural poor population. Other important government scheme: National Social Assistance Programme (Launched on 15th August, 1995). Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana (Launched on 25th December, 2000). Saansad Adarsh Gram Yojana (October 2014).

Q75. 'Sangken' is a festival celebrated in Arunachal Pradesh by people of which of the following religions?

- A) Islam
- B) Buddhism**
- C) Jainism
- D) Hinduism

Solution: 3.(b) Buddhism. Sangken (festival of water) is an annual three-day long festival. The Khampti and Singpho tribes of the Lohit district in

Arunachal Pradesh celebrate it. It is celebrated by the Theravada Buddhist Communities. It is celebrated as Songkran in other Southeast Asian countries. Songkran is the Thai New Year's national holiday. More Buddhists festivals

include Buddha Purnima, Hemis Festival, Losar Festival, Lumbini Festival, Parinirvana Day, Rumtek Chaam Festival and Mani Rimdu Festival.